My Journey Through Unicom TIC

Hi, I am Thenuja Satheeskumar, and this is the story of how the world of IT opened its doors to me when I least expected it. I completed my A/Ls in 2021 in the Bio stream. Medical studies didn't interest me, and university didn't work out. Deep inside, I felt drawn to IT, but I had no idea how to start or where to go. One year slipped by like that, filled with uncertainty. Like many young people, I looked at well-known places such as SLIIT and wondered if Software Engineering could be my path, but the cost of that dream was far beyond my family's situation. I didn't want to stay idle, so I tried freelancing and later joined an institute in Colombo to study networking. My real passion was software, but since that wasn't offered there, I convinced myself that at least networking would help me enter the IT field. I completed a year, but the next steps required more money, more travel, and more stability — none of which I had. I lived in Kilinochchi, and without a job, moving to Colombo was impossible. Although I passed the local exam, the Cisco national exam required a fee that again became a barrier. Everything came back to the same issue: cost. And once again, I didn't know what to do next.

One day, while scrolling through Instagram, I saw something unusual an advertisement from Unicom TIC offering a fully free program. It looked too good to be true. If it was real, it would be life-changing. Still, I didn't apply. I just sent it to my sister who had finished her A/Ls and told her to try. At the very last moment, she remembered and applied for both of us. I didn't think about it again until she returned from a workshop in Jaffna and told me how genuine it seemed. Only then did I check my messages and realize I, too, had been shortlisted — but I had already missed the session. I thought the chance was gone, but when I called and explained, they asked me to join the workshop in Vavuniya instead. That workshop changed everything. I had attended many events before, but this one felt different. There was no pressure about degrees or marks. It was about passion, teamwork, and how we approached problems. I met Neil sir for the first time there. His confidence and encouragement made me feel brave enough to be there. The activities tested not our knowledge, but our interest, commitment, and ability to work with others. For the first time, I felt like I was seen not for what I lacked, but for what I could become.

After the final local exam in Colombo, I waited quietly, trying not to hope too much. Then one day the message arrived: I had been selected for the scholarship program. I was happier than I had ever been even with exam results, because this felt like the first real door that opened in my life. After my interview with Neil sir, I officially started my journey at Unicom TIC on April 1st, 2024.

When the program shifted to Jaffna, a new fear appeared. I was interested in IT, but I had no background in it. I had never taken IT as a subject in school, and my school hadn't even run proper ICT lessons. I had only used the computer for games and Paint. When I walked into the lecture hall, I saw degree holders and experienced students. I felt nervous, but I decided to start anyway. We began with HTML and CSS. The biggest surprise was how friendly and supportive the Unicom SD engineers were. Even the smallest doubt was explained patiently. Our entire learning method was practical: a bit of theory, then straight into the lab to apply it. We learned from mistakes more than from notes, and we slowly understood what the software industry actually expects.

We were divided into small mentoring groups, and our mentors played a huge part in our growth. Any issue—technical or personal—we shared with them, and they helped us solve it without hesitation. As a group, we even conducted a school seminar, which broke our fear of speaking and helped us grow socially. Stage fear slowly disappeared thanks to the way Neil sir and Santha sir constantly encouraged us to speak in front of others. The program didn't just teach coding. We learned management skills, problem-solving, communication, spoken English, and the importance of non-functional requirements in software. Daily coding challenges trained our logical thinking. Industry professionals visited and shared their journeys, motivating us to believe in ourselves.

Step by step, we moved from HTML and CSS to JavaScript, Angular, C#, SQL, and finally full-stack development. The lecturers ranged from software engineers to Tech Leads, all teaching us with passion. Even with heavy workloads, Tech Lead Mayooran sir spent time guiding us, answering doubts, and taking extra classes. Our learning wasn't limited to assignments — it grew into real projects, culminating in three milestones: a frontend project, a backend project, and a full-stack project with deployment. Our final evaluation was done by Santha sir, Neil sir, and Mayooran sir, followed by an HR interview with Programus. By December, the program had come to an end — a beautiful journey filled with learning, support, and unforgettable memories.

On January 5th, 2025, the moment I had dreamed of finally arrived: a Conditional Job Offer from Unicom Connected Apps as a Software Developer. For the first time in my life, I could proudly call myself a software developer. And the reason behind that transformation is **Unicom TIC**. Even now, at CApps, we learn new things every day. We are lucky to have our favourite lecturer, Mayooran sir, as our Tech Lead, guiding us through the real industry. We are working, improving, and growing continuously. Unicom TIC wasn't just a program; it was a life-changing opportunity that opened a door I thought would always remain closed. And for that, I carry deep gratitude. Thank you, Unicom TIC.